

ban, Bolero is primarily semi-urban, Bolero Neo has now started making some inroads into the cities, and XUV300 is split nicely between urban and rural,” says Jejurikar.

What was interesting to Bose when he joined M&M was understanding the DNA of these brands and their audiences. “The challenge here is of a different nature where each brand has a design language but above that, they all have to be a Mahindra. So, how much of ‘Mahindra’ do you put into each of them, and how much of the individual brand do you put? That complexity was interesting to me,” he says.

Bose, who oversees Mahindra Advanced Design Europe (MADE) in the UK and Mahindra India Design Studio (MIDS) in India, says he works in a triangle of art, business and technology, which is will be an important element of the growth story.

Scooping up technology that has nothing to do with traditional cars is R. Velusamy, a powertrain specialist, now heading automotive technology and product development. Velusamy spends his weekends scanning different industries—from smartphones and electronics to movies—to figure out how to get their latest tech inside a car. “Things like 5G, car-to-car connectivity, high-performance chips and touchscreen tech will be a big play. One of the inferences from the tech world that I was very keen to introduce in our cars was [smart assistant] Alexa in the XUV700. The system controls the ability to choose the audio from any seat. We saw it in a

theatre and collaborated with Sony to bring an immersive sound experience into our cars.”

In August 2022, Mahindra unveiled five electric SUVs as part of its Born Electric, or BE Vision. They will be positioned under Mahindra’s two EV brands: XUV and the all-new electric-only brand, BE. Based on Mahindra’s purpose-built INGLO platform and using components from Volkswagen’s MEB platform—thanks to a sourcing arrangement—the SUVs will be launched by end-2024.

Bose says BE is the fifth pillar of M&M’s portfolio. “It has a future-looking aspect to the legendary design that we already have. When we did the BE.05—our first product from BE—we drew inspiration from the Formula E gen3 car of Mahindra Racing [the company’s motor racing team based in the UK]. All Formula E cars have a halo that protects the driver if the car flips over. Our BE.05 is very strongly influenced by this Formula E car because we are going to talk about our race-to-road story, where we are bringing EVs that we race to the road,” he says.

18 PER CENT M&M’S SHARE OF THE UV SEGMENT IN FY23

SUV RIVALS? WHAT RIVALS?

While M&M’s UV sales grew by 52 per cent from FY18 to FY23, the competition is also fast catching up. Passenger car market leader Maruti Suzuki reported a 44 per cent growth in the same period in UVs while Tata

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A CLOSE RACE

With the SUV market more than doubling in the past few years, M&M faces intense competition in the segment

